SENTINEL / CYBER SAFETY AWARENESS

Cyber safety starts here.

Recognize common scams. Protect your accounts. Know what to do next.



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Security Awareness | User Education

Pause. Verify. Protect.

Quick guide

Use these 15 short guides to learn practical safety habits for messages, accounts, payments, devices, shopping, and reporting fraud.

Featured videos

DPC Cyber Security Awareness Campaign Videos - DPC / VPS
Open video on YouTube

Cyber Security Awareness: Phishing and Online Safety - Hasan Bishtawi
Open video on YouTube

SBI Data Exposure: Awareness Video - Video shared by site owner
Open video on YouTube

Binance Security Incident: Awareness Video - YouTube video shared by the site owner
Open video on YouTube

Recent incident awareness

Binance and SBI case summaries are included after this overview. Images are clearly identified as illustrative or building photos, not incident evidence.

Emergency help in India: Call 1930 for cyber financial fraud or use cybercrime.gov.in.

Recent incident / Binance

Security incident awareness



Illustrative image - this is not a photograph of the incident.

What was reported

Binance reported unauthorized withdrawals from its hot wallets on October 29, 2026, with an estimated impact of about $6.3 billion in crypto assets. The company said it would cover the loss and began restoring withdrawals in phases on November 1.

Safety takeaway

Use unique passwords and multi-factor authentication. Be cautious of messages claiming to offer recovery help; verify all account alerts through the official app or website.

Read Binance recovery update

Recent incident / SBI

Customer-data exposure report



Building photo - this is not a photograph of the data incident.

What the website reports

The website summarizes a customer-data exposure report and notes that the source and extent remain under investigation. Treat early claims about affected data cautiously and rely on verified updates from the bank and relevant authorities.

Safety takeaway

Never share your UPI PIN or one-time password with someone claiming to be from a bank. Use your bank app or a verified phone number to confirm unexpected security alerts.

Guide 01 of 15

Spot phishing and fake links

How it works

A scammer pretends to be a bank, delivery company, employer, or government office. They send an urgent email or text with a link to a look-alike sign-in page and collect the password or card details you enter.

Warning signs

- The message creates panic or demands immediate action.
- The sender address or website spelling looks slightly wrong.
- It asks for passwords, OTPs, PINs, or payment through a link.

How to protect yourself

- Open the company app or type its official address yourself.
- Check the full sender address and link destination before opening.
- Never share an OTP or password in reply to a message.
- Report and delete suspicious messages.

Remember
Pause. Verify through a known official channel.

Guide 02 of 15

Protect your passwords

How it works

Attackers try passwords leaked from one service on many other services. Guessable passwords based on names, birthdays, or common words are also tested automatically.

Warning signs

- A login alert arrives that you did not trigger.
- A password reset email appears unexpectedly.
- The same password is used for several accounts.

How to protect yourself

- Use a unique, long password or passphrase for every account.
- Store them in a reputable password manager.
- Change reused passwords, starting with email and banking.
- Never share passwords in chat, email, or phone calls.

Remember
A unique password prevents one breach from unlocking every account.

Guide 03 of 15

Turn on two-factor authentication

How it works

When a password is stolen, scammers try to sign in as you. A second sign-in factor can stop them, though attackers may still trick people into approving a fake sign-in.

Warning signs

- You receive an approval request you did not start.
- Someone calls asking you to read out a login code.
- A sign-in alert names a device or place you do not recognize.

How to protect yourself

- Enable multi-factor authentication in account security settings.
- Prefer an authenticator app or security key where available.
- Never approve a login prompt you did not initiate.
- Save recovery codes somewhere secure and offline.

Remember
A one-time code is a key. Do not read it to anyone.

Guide 04 of 15

Avoid UPI and payment fraud

How it works

A fraudster may send a collect request, show a fake payment screenshot, or claim you must scan a QR code to receive money. Approving a collect request or entering a UPI PIN authorizes a payment.

Warning signs

- Someone asks for your UPI PIN to receive a refund.
- A buyer sends a QR code and says to scan it to get paid.
- A caller pressures you to approve a payment request.

How to protect yourself

- Remember: entering a UPI PIN authorizes money to leave your account.
- Check the payee and amount in your app before approving.
- Confirm incoming payments in your bank app, not in a screenshot.
- Call your bank using the number on its official website or card.

Remember
You do not need a PIN to receive money.

Guide 05 of 15

Stay safe on social media

How it works

Scammers copy photos and public details to impersonate you or a friend. Fake giveaways and investment pitches use trusted-looking profiles to lure people into sharing codes or sending money.

Warning signs

- A friend urgently asks for money from a new account.
- A prize requires an upfront fee or your login details.
- A stranger asks for private photos or personal information.

How to protect yourself

- Verify unusual requests by calling your friend on a known number.
- Make your profile and location details visible only to people you trust.
- Use a unique password and two-factor authentication.
- Report impersonation accounts to the platform.

Remember
Verify a surprising request outside the app where it arrived.

Guide 06 of 15

Secure your phone

How it works

Fake apps, malicious links, and remote-access tools can expose messages, photos, and banking activity. A caller may claim they need remote access to fix a problem or issue a refund.

Warning signs

- Someone asks you to install an app from a link or unknown store.
- Your phone requests unusual permissions for a simple app.
- A stranger asks you to share your screen or install remote access software.

How to protect yourself

- Install apps from official app stores and check the publisher.
- Keep your operating system and apps updated.
- Use a screen lock and enable device-finding features.
- Do not install remote access apps for an unsolicited caller.

Remember
Never let an unknown caller take control of your phone.

Guide 07 of 15

Use public Wi-Fi carefully

How it works

A scammer can create a Wi-Fi hotspot with a familiar name or monitor insecure connections. They may also send a fake sign-in page to capture credentials.

Warning signs

- The network name is slightly different from the venue name.
- Wi-Fi asks for unrelated personal or payment details.
- A pop-up asks you to install a certificate or app.

How to protect yourself

- Ask staff for the exact official Wi-Fi name.
- Use mobile data for banking and sensitive account changes.
- Turn off auto-join for public networks.
- Forget the network when you leave.

Remember
A familiar network name does not prove it is genuine.

Guide 08 of 15

Shop safely online

How it works

Fake stores copy real branding, advertise unusually low prices, take payment, and disappear. Some also collect card details through counterfeit checkout pages.

Warning signs

- A deal is far cheaper than every trusted seller.
- The site has no clear contact, return, or delivery details.
- The payment page redirects to an unrelated address.

How to protect yourself

- Search for independent reviews and verify the store address.
- Use a payment option with buyer protection.
- Avoid bank transfers to unknown sellers.
- Keep order confirmations and payment records.

Remember
A padlock icon alone does not prove a shop is legitimate.

Guide 09 of 15

Recognize job and task scams

How it works

A fake recruiter offers easy high pay, then asks for a registration fee, identity documents, or a deposit to unlock tasks. The apparent earnings may be fictional.

Warning signs

- You must pay money to get a job or withdraw earnings.
- The recruiter uses only messaging apps and avoids a real interview.
- They ask you to move money through your bank account.

How to protect yourself

- Verify the company and job on its official careers website.
- Never pay a fee to secure a job or task.
- Do not let anyone use your bank account to move funds.
- Share identity documents only through a verified hiring process.

Remember
A real employer does not need your money to hire you.

Guide 10 of 15

Protect your data with backups

How it works

Ransomware can lock files and demand payment. Device theft, accidental deletion, and account compromise can also erase access to important data.

Warning signs

- Files suddenly will not open or have unfamiliar extensions.
- A note demands payment to restore files.
- A backup drive is always connected to the computer.

How to protect yourself

- Keep another copy of important files on a separate device or trusted cloud service.
- Disconnect offline backup drives after use.
- Turn on automatic backups and test restoring a file.
- Keep devices updated and avoid unknown attachments.

Remember
A backup is useful only if you can restore it.

Guide 11 of 15

Protect your privacy

How it works

Scammers piece together public details such as your birthday, workplace, family, and travel plans to impersonate you or make convincing targeted messages.

Warning signs

- Apps request access unrelated to what they do.
- Old accounts still hold personal information.
- Public posts reveal routines, travel, or identity details.

How to protect yourself

- Review app permissions and remove access you no longer need.
- Limit who can see your profile, posts, and location.
- Delete accounts you no longer use.
- Avoid posting identity details that could answer account recovery questions.

Remember
Share less publicly; it gives impersonators less to work with.

Guide 12 of 15

Help children stay safe online

How it works

A scammer or bully may contact a child through games or social apps, pretend to be a peer, and ask for private details, images, money, or secrecy.

Warning signs

- A person asks a child to move to a private chat.
- They request images, passwords, or location information.
- A child seems worried about messages or pressured to keep secrets.

How to protect yourself

- Agree on simple rules for sharing photos, location, and personal details.
- Keep conversations open and respond calmly if something happens.
- Use age-appropriate privacy and family safety settings.
- Save evidence and report harmful contact to the platform and trusted authorities.

Remember
Make it easy for a child to ask for help without fear of blame.

Guide 13 of 15

Spot deepfakes and impersonation

How it works

AI-generated audio or video can imitate a relative, public figure, or manager. Scammers use the familiar voice to create urgency and request money, codes, or confidential information.

Warning signs

- An urgent request asks you to keep it secret.
- The person requests money or a code through an unusual channel.
- The voice or video feels convincing but the request is unexpected.

How to protect yourself

- Call the person back using a number you already know.
- Agree on a family verification phrase for emergencies.
- Verify financial requests with a second person or channel.
- Do not rely on a voice recording or video alone as proof.

Remember
Verify identity through a separate, trusted channel.

Guide 14 of 15

What to do after a cyber incident

How it works

After a scam, attackers may try again using the information you gave them. Quick action can help secure accounts, contact financial providers, and preserve evidence.

Warning signs

- An unexpected payment or account change appears.
- You shared an OTP, password, or identity document.
- Your account sends messages you did not write.

How to protect yourself

- Contact your bank or payment provider immediately using an official number.
- In India, call 1930 promptly for financial cyber fraud and report at cybercrime.gov.in.
- Change affected passwords from a trusted device and sign out other sessions.
- Save messages, transaction IDs, phone numbers, and screenshots.

Remember
Report quickly. Never pay someone who promises guaranteed recovery.

Guide 15 of 15

Keep learning and verify sources

How it works

Scammers adapt their stories to current events and new technology. Forwarded warnings can also be false, so sharing without checking may spread misinformation.

Warning signs

- A warning demands you forward it immediately.
- A post has no date, named source, or link to an official advisory.
- A stranger claims a new trick can guarantee instant money or protection.

How to protect yourself

- Check current advisories from CERT-In and official government sources.
- Verify claims with more than one trusted source before forwarding.
- Learn one small safety habit and share it with family or colleagues.
- Report cybercrime through the official portal.

Remember
Pause, verify the source, then decide whether to share.

Need help?

If you shared a password or code

Change the affected password from the official app or website, sign out other sessions, and enable multi-factor authentication. Contact the service through a known support channel.

If money may have been stolen

Call your bank immediately. In India, call 1930 and report at cybercrime.gov.in. Save transaction details, messages, phone numbers, and screenshots.

Contact the site owner

+91 93733 40903

This PDF is a reading companion to the Sentinel website. Verify time-sensitive incident details against official sources.